SpeechGeek



Season Eleven: Winter 2014

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As 2013 marches boldly and coldly toward its final days, the online monolith that is Amazon is experimenting with its drone delivery service. Though (at the time of this publication) customers won't anticipate their bulk orders of lip balm to be delivered by autonomous robots until at least 2015, folks are increasingly curious about the most efficient way to obtain their purchases. While we certainly respect the innovation and sheer "woah"-ness of the delivery drones, your friendly neighborhood **SpeechGeek** plans to stick with our current strategy of providing prompt digital downloads for online purchases. As recognized digital publishers by the National Forensic League, your electronic copy of **SpeechGeek** scripts is all you need to get competing. Don't forget your suit, though. That's pretty important, too.

If you're in need of printed scripts, stopwatches, or buttons – we still have you covered! While we can't promise delivery via an automated drone just yet (maybe by the time we're publishing Season Thirty), we do promise to package and ship your items at quickly as our human hands can do it. Welcome to a new year and five new interp scripts!

Corey Alderdice
Publisher

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Pigskin

by Richard Shelton

SCENE ONE

MARK. Every family has rituals. Some involve particular foods, places, or behaviors. Our ritual centers on the pigskin.

DAD. Get 'yer jersey on, son. The game is about to begin.

MARK. My earliest memories practically have buffalo sauce stains. My father and I would sit next to each other on the couch, surrounded by the weekly smorgasbord of junky food my otherwise healthy mother would lovingly prepare.

DAD. (*shouting at television*) Come on, Murphries, you better deliver a victory this time.

MARK. Outside of football, my dad and I couldn't be more different. I guess you could say I was a bit softer than my dad. I preferred to read and listen to music while he…

DAD. (*screaming*) Murphries? What? Was there a bone in the Gatorade? BECAUSE YOU'RE CHOKING!

MARK. …was tougher than me. Very tough.

DAD. You've gotta be kidding me! Can't you take a hit?

MARK. As I got older, high school football seemed like the obvious path way to a little bit of father-son bonding. Unfortunately, the only one I ended up bonding with was J.T.

J.T. (*taunting MARK)* Come on, Mark. You'd better deliver a victory this time.

MARK. I don't know what made him tic.

J.T. What? Was there a bone in your Gatorade? Because you're choking.

MARK. But I knew one thing.

J.T. (*shoves)* Can't you take a hit?

MARK. He wouldn't be content until I was sacked.

SCENE TWO

(*MARK and J.T. are in uniform during a practice. The scene freezes when MARK addresses the audience.*)

J.T. (*grunts and stretches*) Hunh! Ungh! Ahhh… I tell you something, nothing gets me going like crushing bodies on a Saturday morning, eh?

MARK. (*to himself, rolling his eyes and adjusting his mouth guard)* Yeah, right.

J.T. What?

MARK. Huh?

J.T. What did you say?

MARK. Oh, nothing.

J.T. (*moves a bit closer to him*) So, you're telling me you didn't just mumble something under your breath?

The Dragon Slayer...

by Sarah Carpenter

At this time of day, while the sun sits perched upon its invisible altar, calm is usually what fills the air. But today, the smell of hydrogen sulfide fills the ether like milk flooding a cereal bowl. We humans are just raisins and bran floating around in it. My compatriots search frantically for the origin of the eye watering stench. "Is it a gas leak? Accident in the chemistry labs? Backdraft from Burrito Tuesday in the cafeteria?"

I scoff a grizzled, "Heh," at the poor, hapless fools. I'd love to be as clueless as them. That would have provided me with a soft, comfortable life. They need me to be tough. They need a hero. They need me to…

"Get out of the way, Lady Lame-a-lot," sneers Lacy, the WASPy blonde wearing too much vanilla scented body mist. She smells like a cookie and her voice crackles like Rice Krispies. Come to think of it, I really wish I had eaten breakfast this morning.

"Good 'morrow, Lacy," I say politely, attempting to rise above the hateful flames of the wicked beast. "How goes the day?"

"Eww, she's talking to me," Lacy snorts, "Somebody, quick, disinfect my face."

I want respond with, "I could disinfect it, WITH MY SWORD YOU VILLAINOUS SHE-DEMON!" But I don't. I'm already the "weird girl"—the one who wears floor length skirts and corseted (yet completely within dress code) blouses to school. My hair is dyed three shades darker than the natural color and braided down to the middle of my back. I prefer the company of my teachers to my peers. They at least get my jokes. I carry around a journal the way other girls carry around lip gloss and concealer. You take one look at me and you know exactly the kind of person you're dealing with.

Alas, were only such a fairy tale real for geeky gals such as myself. See, it's only cool to watch *Game of Thrones*, not read it. If you read the series three years ago over summer vacation, as I did, you wouldn't act so shocked the day after. For girls, it's cooler to know the actors in the superhero movies than be able to name off all the inaccuracies in them. Don't even try to partake in a Saturday afternoon of live-action role playing if you value your social status in the slightest bit.

I'm smart enough to know that this is temporary. There's a whole Internet full of folks like me out there. I'm just biding my time until I can graduate. Still, I want to leave with some dignity. So, I keep my head down, remain kind, and fill my gaping social calendar with writing fantasy pieces.

I scribble down fragments of stories. It's no "Great American Novel," but it is the

escape I anxiously anticipate in real life. Good triumphs over evil, courage is rewarded, there are dragons and monsters, tragedy and romance. The best part is the option to rewrite the people around me. Teachers become gatekeeping ogres or wizened allies. My sneering peers are turned into monsters, villains, and slain enemies. I save the best for myself—the parts of me that remain invisible to the naked eye are magnified. In my stories, I'm dynamic and charming while my jokes receive thundering laughter. I triumph over obstacles. I am appreciated. I am celebrated. When I'm feeling low, I revisit the stories and they give me strength.

I don't know exactly when I misplaced my journal. I don't know if I dropped it under my desk or accidentally left in the restroom. I don't know how Lacy got her hands on it, but I did know within seconds what was happening the moment I saw her stand up in the middle of the cafeteria.

"How about a little story time with lunch today?" she shouted over the vibrating chatter of people eating. "…The first morning I laid my eyes upon the rugged warrior Jason, I knew the stars had aligned…" Her shrill voice ricocheted off the walls. She was like a siren, but instead of a sea monster luring sailors to their doom she was a gorgeous teen girl bent on destroying my life. Given the option, I'd prefer to deal with a sea harpy.

"…Jason stood, auburn hair dancing in the wind while he stood brandishing his sword…"

This is my certain doom.

"…beneath his foot laid the dying corpse of the murderous dragon sputtering its final, blood-soaked breaths…"

A few scenarios run through my mind. In the first scenario, I literally melt into a fleshy puddle. My ears evaporate and the people I once called classmates step to the side to avoid getting my flesh goo on their shoes. The second scenario involved Lacy delightfully bursting into a cloud of confetti out of the universe's collective need to vanquish such an entity of pure evil. On a long shot, the third scenario involved some courageous classmates standing up and applauding the literary masterpiece leaving my tormentor looking gob smacked and stupefied.

"…the journey leading up to this defining moment started precisely twenty-three days earlier…"

Then it hits me. This is my defining moment. For so many years, I've walked through these halls trying my hardest to just survive. My head was kept down. I avoided confrontation with girls like Lacy at all costs. I smiled and waved but never shook the boat. Why did I reserve the best parts of myself for pages that would never be read by anyone else? What's the point in pretending to be a heroine in a book if I'm just going to cower in real life? My alter ego didn't need others to rescue her in my

stories. Why should I wait for someone to rescue me?

"Listen, Lacy…" I jump to feet with heroic intent. When everyone's eyes fall on me, I realize there's no going back. "I've never been anything but polite to you. I'm a good person, and despite the way you treat everyone else, I think that deep down you're a good person, too."

During my mini-monologue, I lock eyes with Lacy. For the first time in all the years of her tormenting me, I see something different. It isn't the bitter, icy glare of a cruel beast but a look of sheer terror. She's always been told she's beautiful, but she's never been told that she's loveable. Suddenly, she's vulnerable. It's so much easier to be a monster. It is easier to breathe fire and roar to keep others away than risk being hurt. I may not fit in with everyone else, but I'm okay with that. I know who I am. The real Lacy, a sensitive and insecure girl, has been locked away in a tower. She acts like a monster because she's terrified someone will find out who she really is.

"Whatever, weirdo," she mumbles under her breath as she tosses my journal in my direction. She walks away and doesn't say anything to me for the rest of the year.

It's funny, really. I didn't wake up this morning feeling particularly brave or bold. But in one fell swoop, I have both delivered the fatal blow to the beast while opening the door for the maiden locked away in the tower. Whether Lacy will walk through the door to show the world her true self is another chapter. For now though, I shall walk tall as the dragon slayer of Eastman Senior High.